



Making a bootable USB with **Rufus** involves flashing an operating system's image (ISO) file directly onto the drive. Unlike Ventoy, this process prepares the drive for one specific OS at a time and will **erase all existing data** on the USB.

Phase 1: Preparation

1. **Backup Data:** Ensure your USB drive (minimum **8GB** recommended) does not contain important files.
2. **Download Rufus:** Get the latest version from the [official Rufus website](https://rufus.ie/). It is a "portable" app, so no installation is required—just run the `.exe` file.
3. **Get the ISO:** Ensure you have the ISO file for your desired OS (e.g., [Windows 11](#) or [Ubuntu](#)).

Phase 2: Configuring Rufus

1. **Insert USB:** Plug your drive into the PC. Rufus should automatically detect it under the **Device** dropdown.
2. **Select the ISO:** Under **Boot selection**, ensure "Disk or ISO image" is chosen, then click the **SELECT** button to locate your downloaded ISO file.
3. **Choose Partition Scheme:**
 - **GPT:** Recommended for modern computers (UEFI).
 - **MBR:** Use this for older computers with a legacy BIOS.
4. **Target System:** This will typically auto-set to **UEFI (non-CSM)** for GPT or **BIOS (or UEFI-CSM)** for MBR.
5. **Volume Label:** You can optionally rename the drive (e.g., "Windows11_Install").
6. **File System:** Leave this as the default (usually **NTFS** for Windows or **FAT32** for others).

Phase 3: Creating the Drive

1. **Start:** Click the **START** button at the bottom.
2. **Customise (Windows 11 only):** If prompted with a "Windows User Experience" window, select any bypasses you need (like **TPM/Secure Boot** or creating a **local account**) and click **OK**.
3. **Confirm Formatting:** A final warning will appear stating that all data will be destroyed. Click **OK** to begin.
4. **Wait:** The status bar will show progress. When it turns fully green and says **READY**, the process is complete.
5. **Eject:** Close Rufus and safely eject your USB drive.

Phase 4: Using the Drive

To use the drive, insert it into the target PC, restart, and tap your **Boot Menu Key** (often **F12**, **F8**, or **Esc**) to select the USB as the primary boot device.

